

September 23, 2026

The Editors

JACC: Clinical Electrophysiology

Dear Editors,

Please consider my Research Letter entitled “Reader Disagreement Identifies Residual Diagnostic Risk in Automated Arrhythmia ECG Interpretation” for publication in *JACC: Clinical Electrophysiology*.

This retrospective secondary analysis examined whether disagreement between cardiologists identifies ECGs with persistent diagnostic difficulty despite adjudication. Using the publicly available CODE datasets, ECGs with reader disagreement showed substantially greater patient-level diagnostic error risk than consensus ECGs, and this excess risk persisted across retained coverage despite uncertainty-based referral reducing overall error burden. These findings suggest that reader disagreement carries clinically relevant information about interpretive difficulty that is lost when expert assessments are collapsed into a single adjudicated reference label.

The study used only publicly available, de-identified data. No additional ethical or institutional review board approval was obtained for this secondary analysis. The source CODE study was approved by the Research Ethics Committee of the Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais (protocol 49368496317.7.0000.5149).

I confirm that:

1. This manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere.
2. None of its contents have been previously published.
3. I have read and approved the submitted manuscript.
4. I have no conflicts of interest or relevant relationships with industry.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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